

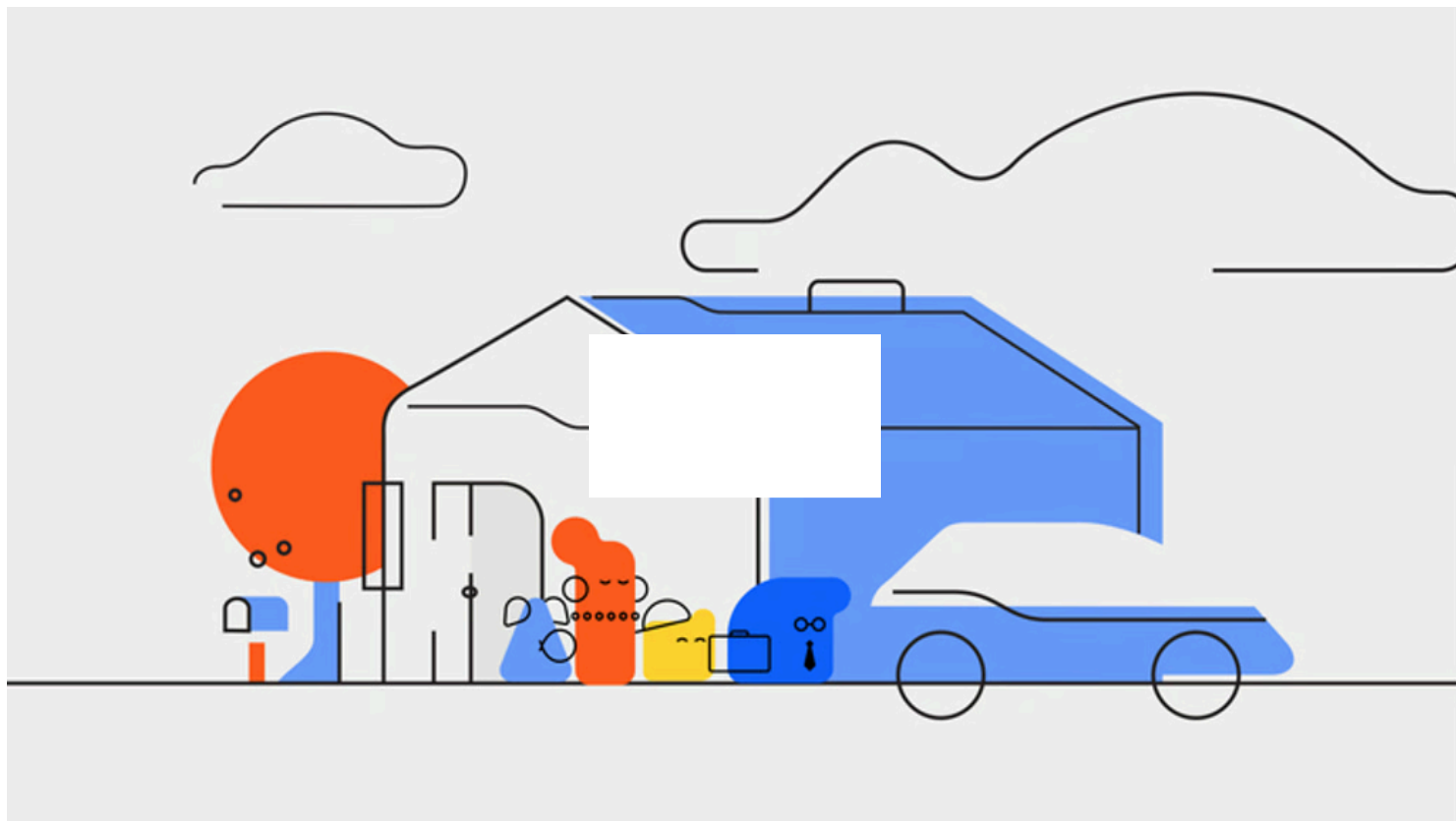
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## Zensmith - the "Life Operating System"

Welcome to the Natural Way of Working!

**Zensmith**

First created • 0 backed

More

**\$47** 

pledged of \$40,250 goal

**4**

backers



Software



Toronto, Canada

### Funding Unsuccessful

The project's funding goal was not reached on Mon, January 20 2020 3:50 AM UTC +06:00

 **Last updated** [January 20, 2020](#)[Campaign](#)[Rewards](#)[Creator](#)[FAQ](#)[Updates](#) <sup>0</sup>[Comments](#) <sup>0</sup>

## Story

### Funding period

Nov 21 2019 - Jan 20 2020 (60 days)



## Welcome to the Natural Way of Working!

Are you a Freelancer or a Knowledge Worker?

Are you someone involved in busy projects, with no time for family, friends and social life? Do you want to have discretionary time?

Do you want to manage every aspect of your life in one place, not just work?

Take this chance to experiment yourself with the **Life Operating System...** supporting us to build a decentralized working space, where there are no organizational barriers and where all the actors of the Freelance Economy can collaborate seamlessly.

If you are not involved in busy projects but know people working to make a better planet take this chance to help them access a valuable tool for free!! Be their **sponsor**.

We will give the Zensmith application and services to **non-profits** (NGOs: non-governmental organizations) for **free**.

**Why we are in Kickstarter ?** There are no simple solutions to complex problems. Because human work is complex our solution is difficult to explain in words or images, it must be used to "feel" the difference. We want to arrive to that milestone in order that You can try it. Nobody in the "investment world" has the patience to try to understand our product. They want miraculous products explained in 8 slides!! We hope that more open-minded and progressive people will read our proposal.



## Our Story

We are two seasoned Project Managers that have been around the corporate world for over three decades (you can guess...we are Baby Boomers !!!!).

At the beginning of our careers we suffered the old style of doing things: no clear targets, every day changing priorities, coordination problems, organization silos, scarce team collaboration, ....

As a result we worked too many hours, had little time for family, and friends → an unbalanced life, and yes, we regret it. At that time we had no options.

So, each of us in parallel, searched for any tool to improve our quality of life; the management of the famous work-personal divide.

The cloud era offered us many applications. New apps appeared each year and then each month. So each year/month we renewed our quest for the "magical tool".

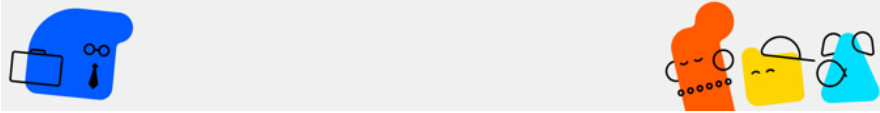
We tried them all: Gantt based PM apps, ToDo lists, Mindmaps, Group Collaboration Task Management Systems, KanBan boards and, because it is popular, Slack too. Yes, surely they are better compared to e-mail, but not what a "PM geek" needs.

4 years ago we met by chance and shared our experiences. We joined forces and started to research for a real solution. We wanted to leave our mark in this busy world giving the new generations a new way of doing meaningful things. It is something we really care of, our challenge.

As a result of our research we were "human work activity" experts, but were stuck, we didn't see how the process could be improved.

And one day.... Eureka!!.... we suddenly realized that it wasn't a matter of

methodology or technology but to **change the point of view. !!!**

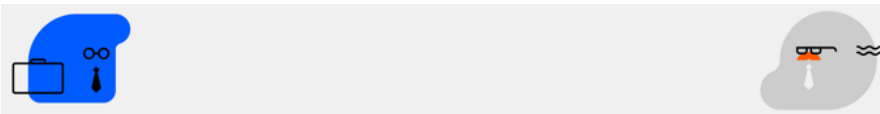


## The Paradigm Shift

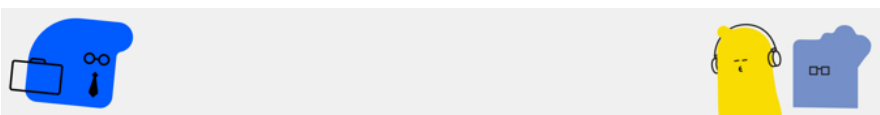


So using all the knowledge gathered in our research we started designing the app around this principle. We implemented the different workflows based on a mix of ideas of every methodology; an eclectic solution.

Zensmith and the **"natural way of working"** were born.



## The solution

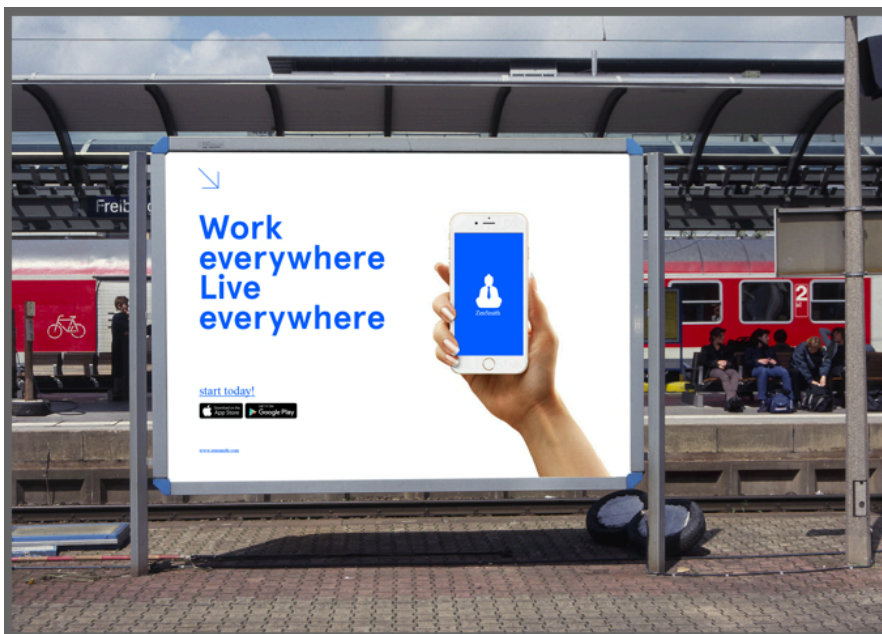


## The results

As my father said: "a different approach gives different results"



**And remember...everything meaningful we do in life is a project!!! (big or small)**



## Knowledge Sharing

We will create a free space for the community to share their experiences. Members will be able to share their workflows and improve them collectively.

## 3P - People, Planet and Profits

We learned from Millennials and Centennials, that we must do something for the planet.

As explained in the beginning, we will be giving the Zensmith application services to **non-profits** for free.

Non-profits develop projects all around the world to solve critical problems for the future of the planet. We think our app will help them be successful. Is the way we think we can help.

We will commit up to 25% of our operational resources to host NGOs teams. The 75% paying customers will support the non-profit users.

During the campaign you will have, through the rewards system, a way to support your preferred non-profit.

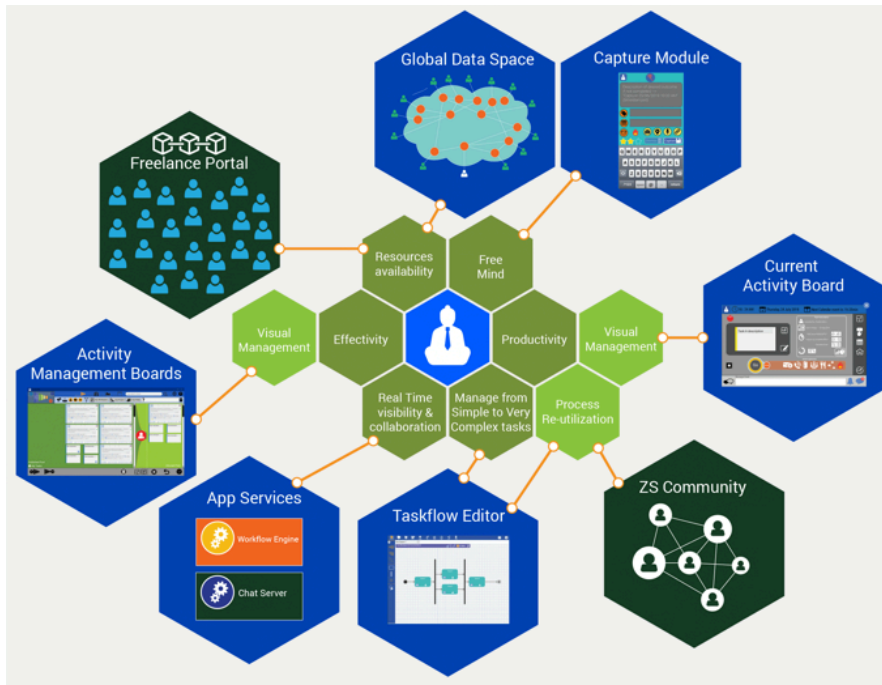
## Our timeline

We already finished the Inception and Design Phase of the application and developed a module with the critical functions to validate internally the feasibility of the whole application.

We plan to start the remaining developments in January 2020 and have the MVP (Minimum Viable Product) for May to start Beta testing. We plan the MVP launch for July 2020. The complementary functions will be developed and delivered in an ongoing basis.



## The different modules



During our research we found a report from a market analysis consulting firm that classified the project/task management apps in 4 families:

- **Communication centered** applications (Outlook, Whatsapp, Slack, Skype, ...).
- **Document centered** applications (Sharepoint, Flickr, del. icious, Wufoo, ...).
- **Social Interaction centered** applications (Yammer, ..).
- **Activity centered** applications (Trello, Jira, Asana, Wrike, Podio, Oracle Primavera ....).

We consider Zensmith is creating a new category; it is an **Individual Centered Application**.

**Introduce a new paradigm!!** Really challenging, but we are committed to show how our ideas can impact positively in busy people.

We are fully convinced we are doing something great that will improve the quality of your life.

## A thoroughly studied UX



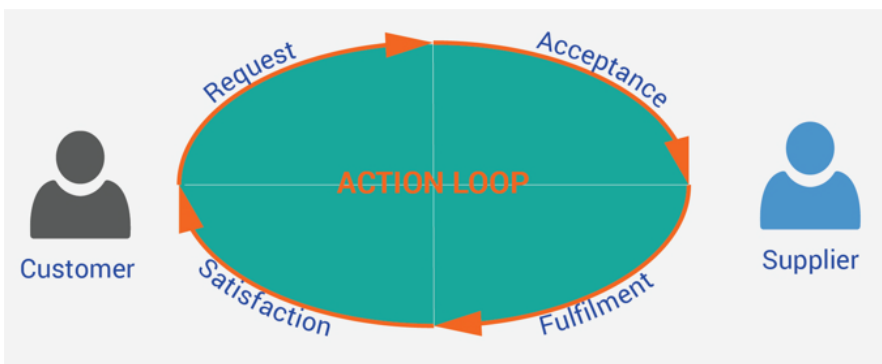
Human work is complex. Most of the existing solutions ask you to adapt your real process to their pre-defined workflow. We acknowledge complexity, embrace it, but give you a means to manage it.

During the **planning phase** we provide a Taskflow Editor to “cut the elephant in pieces” if the task is complex. No limitations you can design simple or complex workflows.

During the **execution phase** Zensmith provides Visual Management, the ability to filter your tasks and focus according to your “current context”. That's what we call “focus management”.

## The functional principles behind our solution

### The Action Loop



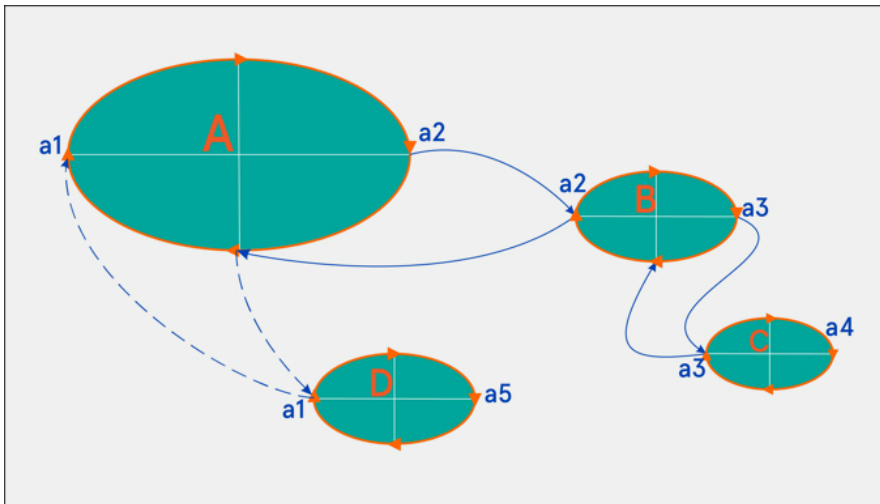
Each task has 2 central actors, the customer and the supplier and 4 phases.

- **Phase 1:** The customer request the task to the supplier
- **Phase 2:** the supplier accepts the task

- **Phase 3:** the supplier executes the tasks
- **Phase4:** the client evaluates the output of the task and if it is according to the requirements gives its approval / satisfaction.

No matter the nature of the task; ask your kid to cut the grass or command the development of a spaceship, **the cycle must be honored in every case.**

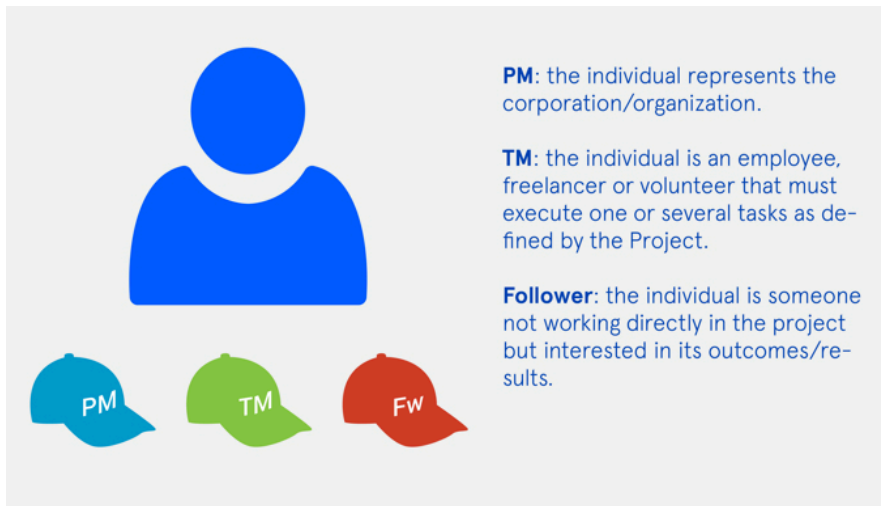
Each phase can be "outsourced" to a "sub-level" supplier. As an example, one of my kids, during high school, when asked to cut the lawn will accept but finally outsource it to a classmate in exchange for a math exam support.



Zensmith will provide a means to manage all the involved actors and track the whole work advance.

## Role Based Functions

In the context of a particular project, the **individual** plays one and only one defined operational role: **Project Manager (PM)**, **Team Member (TM)** or **Follower**.

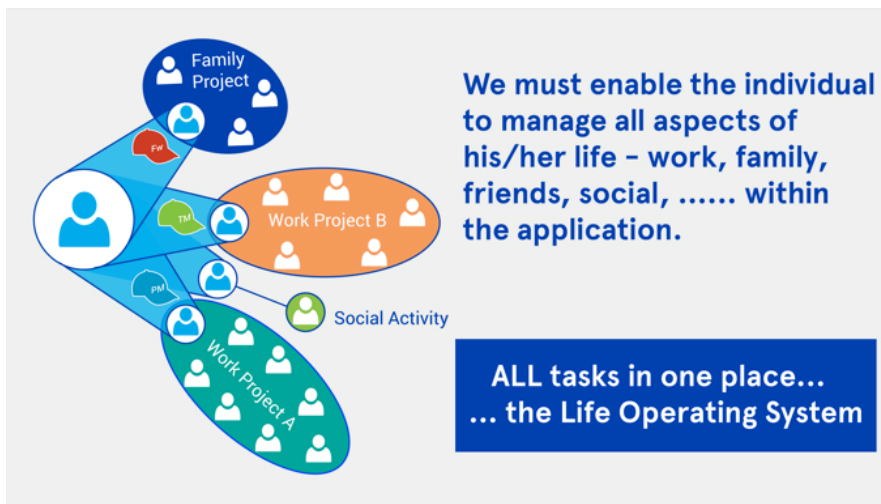


Zensmith is role oriented. It focuses on the individual's effectivity and productivity while playing the defined roles in each project.

**Trinity:** An individual can be involved in several projects at same time. He/She can play anyone of this 3 roles in each of them. It is possible though that he/she acts as PM, TM or Fw in the same timeframe for different projects.

## Holistic Approach

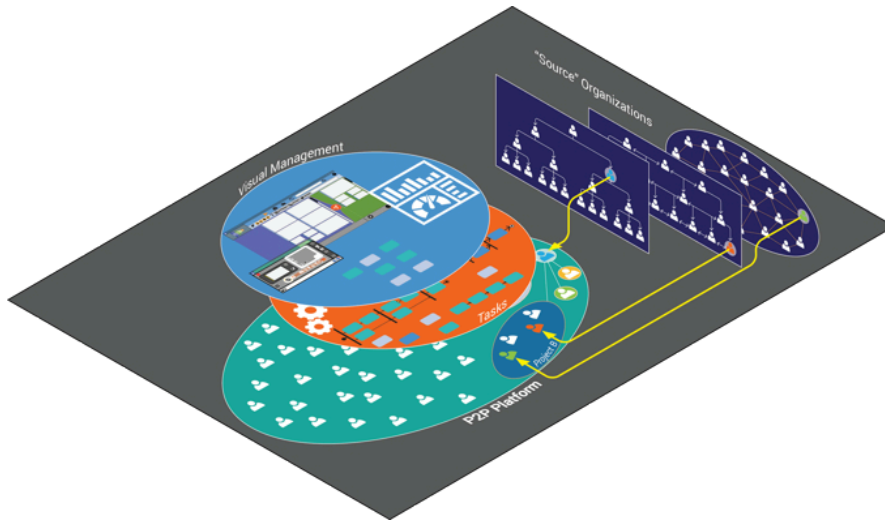
The Zensmith approach is Holistic.



The clear management of the work-personal divide will impact positively in the individual's life and, as a result, in the Corporate Value through his/her intervention as Team Member, Project Manager or Follower in the corresponding projects.

## The Layers

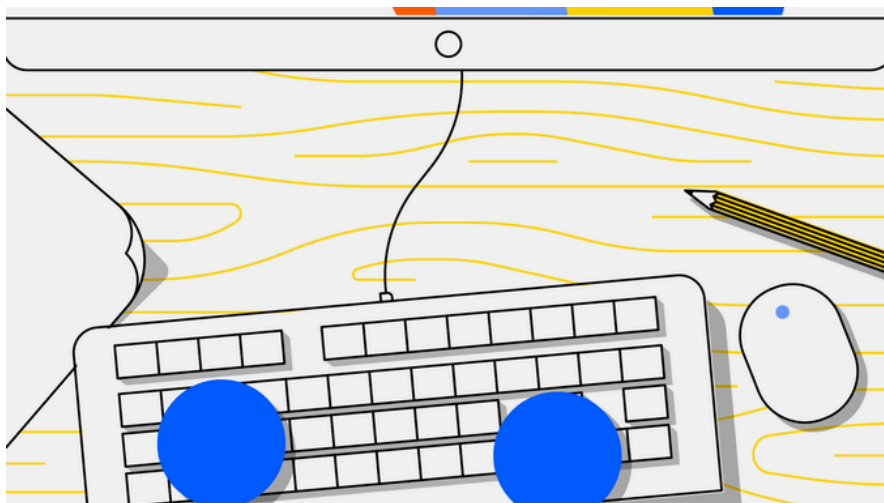
To fulfill the functional principles, Zensmith is organized in 3 layers:



1st layer: the **Project Space** is a P2P network. The PM creates a project in his "workspace" and invites the team members and followers.

2nd layer: the **Task's Space** supports tasks' structuring, assignments and dependencies management. Allows to match the workflow tho the activity life cycle.

3rd layer: **Visual Management** layer that allows the user to have a macro and micro vision of the activities he/she is involved in. Enables the user to decide what action to do next according to the actual context.



## Our research

Our research started dissecting the different project&time management methodologies (PMBOK, Prince2, V-Modell XT, Lean&Agile, Theory of

Constraints, Concurrent Engineering, Activity Theory, GTD, team management concepts, ...).

Also, we tried every app in the market (over 300!) and tested its functions and workflows.

Then we started to analyze the impact of culture, technology, sociology and neurosciences in modern work.

As a clear example of culture impact, in the early 2.000s **millennials** entered the workforce and started to reshape the workplace. They proposed to share knowledge, to have social interactions, wanted to experiment the freedom of working anywhere and anytime → telecommuting and flextime is becoming the norm. The **New Way of Working** (NWW) was born.

Clever generation!!!! Is what we wanted in the old days but no-one imagined will be possible to accomplish. They made it possible, and the rest of us benefited from their move.

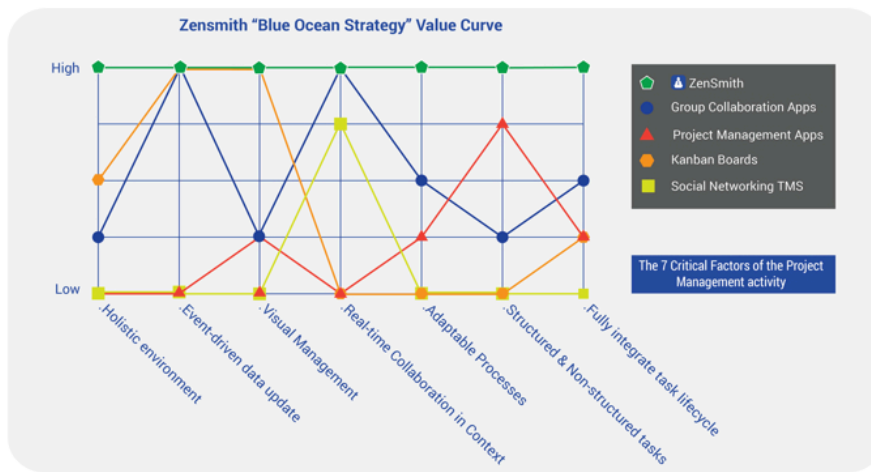
In the last years tools evolved to be mobile, communicating and sharing knowledge almost instantaneously; but there was no real advance.

Projects continue to fail at a **50% failure rate** \* and people are still stressed. (\* Sources: IAG Consulting, Standish Group, McKinsey, PWC and HBR).

When we discovered **our new way of doing things**, with all the knowledge gathered through our years of research we **designed** the workflow . It is tailored to respond to the new requirements. We simulated all the use cases that may arise and were happy to find that responds completely to our expectations.

## How we compare to the rest!

As part of our study and research we concluded that there are 7 critical functional characteristic that a system must comply to fulfill the requirements imposed by modern work.



Zensmith besides its innovative workflow can manage the typical project management functions and also advanced ones like:

- Top-down and bottom-up approach
- Rolling-wave planning
- Hybrid PM
- Collaborative Planning
- "Black-box" outsourcing
- Twin tasks

## Risks and challenges

Zensmith is the acceptance of a different way of doing things.

Initially, we will target start-ups, small innovation groups and freelancers as initial users. We are sure that they will spread the advice of the benefits of using the tool to the rest.

Technically, we see no risks. We have chosen modern technical platforms actually in production by the "big ones".

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